

● Synapse

Connect Google Analytics (GA4) — end-to-end setup & test guide

What this is for. Google Analytics gives Synapse the traffic side of the picture — sessions, conversion rate, channel mix and top pages — to sit alongside the commerce data from Shopify. In production each founder authorizes their own Google account once; Synapse reads their GA4 property *read-only* and nothing about any one property is hardcoded. The dashboard always reads whichever property the current visitor connected (via a signed session cookie).

Does it work with a low-traffic property?

Connecting: yes — OAuth doesn't care how much traffic the property has. The connection succeeds either way.

Getting a customized answer: needs a little traffic. With an empty property the data pull comes back near-zero and the brief leans on commerce data instead. Real founders never hit this — their sites already have weeks of sessions. For a test property, let it collect a day or two of real visits first.

1. Have a GA4 property

You need a **Google Analytics 4** property with the tag installed and collecting on your site. You do **not** need to find the Property ID — after you authorize, Synapse auto-selects your first GA4 property.

2. Create a Google Cloud project

`console.cloud.google.com` → project picker → **New Project** → name it “Synapse”.

3. Enable the Google Analytics Data API

In that project: **APIs & Services** → **Library** → search `Google Analytics Data API` → **Enable**. This is the API Synapse calls to read sessions and channels.

4. Configure the OAuth consent screen

- **APIs & Services** → **OAuth consent screen** → User type **External** → Create.
- App name “Synapse”, your support email, developer email.
- Add the scope `.../auth/analytics.readonly` (read-only Analytics).
- While the app is in **Testing**, add your own Google account under **Test users** (or hit Publish).

5. Create the OAuth client & get the keys

- **APIs & Services** → **Credentials** → **Create credentials** → **OAuth client ID** → type **Web application** → name “Synapse”.
- **Authorized redirect URI** (must match character-for-character):
`https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app/api/auth/google/callback`
- Copy: **Client ID** → this is `GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID`, **Client secret** → this is `GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET`.

If the redirect URI is even slightly off, Google rejects the callback with `redirect_uri_mismatch`.

6. Add env vars to Vercel — then redeploy

This is the one part only you can do. These go on the Vercel project that serves `synapse-acceleration.vercel.app` (your teammate's project), not just your local machine.

In that project's **Settings** → **Environment Variables**, add:

Name	Value
<code>GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID</code>	the Client ID from step 5
<code>GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	the Client secret from step 5
<code>APP_URL</code>	<code>https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app</code>

The read-only scope is already baked in — you don't set it yourself. Then **Redeploy** (env vars only take effect on a new deploy).

7. Test the flow

1. Go to `https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app/dashboard`
2. In the **Google Analytics** card, click **Connect Google Analytics**
3. Google shows the account picker + a read-only Analytics consent screen (proves the client + redirect are right) → approve
4. You land back on the dashboard; the card shows ● **Connected** and Synapse has auto-selected your first GA4 property
5. Traffic now feeds the weekly brief — **sessions, conversion, channel mix and top pages**

Until those env vars are set + deployed, the Google Analytics card shows “Connection coming soon” instead of the connect button — that's the graceful fallback, not a bug.

Good to know

- **Read-only.** Synapse only ever reads — the scope is `analytics.readonly` , so it can't change anything in your account.
- **Refresh handled.** A refresh token is stored on connect, so the weekly brief keeps working without re-authorizing.
- **Multiple properties.** If your account has several GA4 properties, Synapse currently takes the first one; a property picker is on the backlog.

The mental model. Shopify tells Synapse what sold; Google Analytics tells it where the traffic came from and how well it converted. Connect both and the weekly brief reasons across demand *and* attribution.